Use the Lineart mode in the scanner software to scan line-arts

image until you get the precise reference colour. Finally, crop out the scanned reference colour card.

Scanning magazines

Scans of magazines or newspapers often result in dotted image patterns, commonly referred to as moiré. Minimise this effect by scanning the image at 300 dpi with the scanner software's Descreen filter on, and then re-sizing it to 33 per cent of its size using photo-editing software such as Photoshop. Finally, apply the Unsharp Mask filter.

Scanning line-art

Line-art is a clip art, drawing or pencil sketch, consisting of two colours. There are three methods of scanning line-art. The first is the Black and White Mode, or 1-bit scanning that just picks up the black areas. This method suits line-art that does not have shades akin to that of pencil sketches as it keeps the image size to the minimum. Remember to resize and rotate at the time of scanning, to preserve the final image quality.

The other method is the grayscale mode, or 8-bit scanning that records shades of grey. This results in much larger files, but it's suitable for line-art with shades. The third method—halftone—is a format that prints black dots in a manner that simulates shades of grey.

Scanning for fax

Scanning at 200 dpi in Line Art mode, 100 per cent is most suitable when the image has to be faxed. The easiest method would be to print the image to the fax driver directly from your scanner program. Fax always uses the Line Art mode—even if you scan it in some other mode, the fax software converts it into Line Art.

Scanning oversized images

If the image to be scanned is larger than your scanner glass, but its longest side is smaller than the double the longest side of your scanners glass, you can follow this method:

Make a mark after every eight inches on the longest side of the image from the right to the left. Now, rotate the image by 180 degrees and mark it in the same manner, on the opposite longest side. Here, we assume that the image has a landscape orientation, i.e., its width is greater than its height. Now, align the upper-right corner of the image with that of the scanner glass. Choose the settings at which you want to scan the whole image and start the scan. Save this file as Image1.tif. Move the image to the next mark and scan without altering the settings. Save this file as image2.tif. Repeat the process till you have scanned the entire image. To scan the lower half of the image, turn the painting by 180° and repeat the above process. This time use a different naming convention like lower1.tif, lower2.tif. This is necessary because we will have to flip these lower images before creating the final image.

Scan images larger than the scanning area by dividing it into sections

Open all the images in Photoshop. Create layers for each image by clicking ***Layer > New > Layer from Background***. Rotate the canvas by clicking ***Image > Rotate Canvas > 180°*** for all the lower-half images. Create a new blank image, large enough to accommodate all these images. Put all the layers on this image and align them appropriately to get the final picture. You can also use Photoshop CS's (Creative Suite) Photomerge feature to automate the last step.

Saving scanned images

Save images scanned to be used on the Web or be sent as e-mail attachments in the .JPEG format. . GIF is a better option for images such as line arts that have less than 256 colours since it results in smaller file sizes.

If you plan to edit the images later, save them in an uncompressed format. You may also save them in the TIF format as it allows compressing without causing loss of image quality. If you are scanning images for archival, it's always recommended that you save one copy in your image editor's native format. For example, if you use Photoshop, save a copy in the PSD format. You might want to save the second copy in high quality JPEG format.